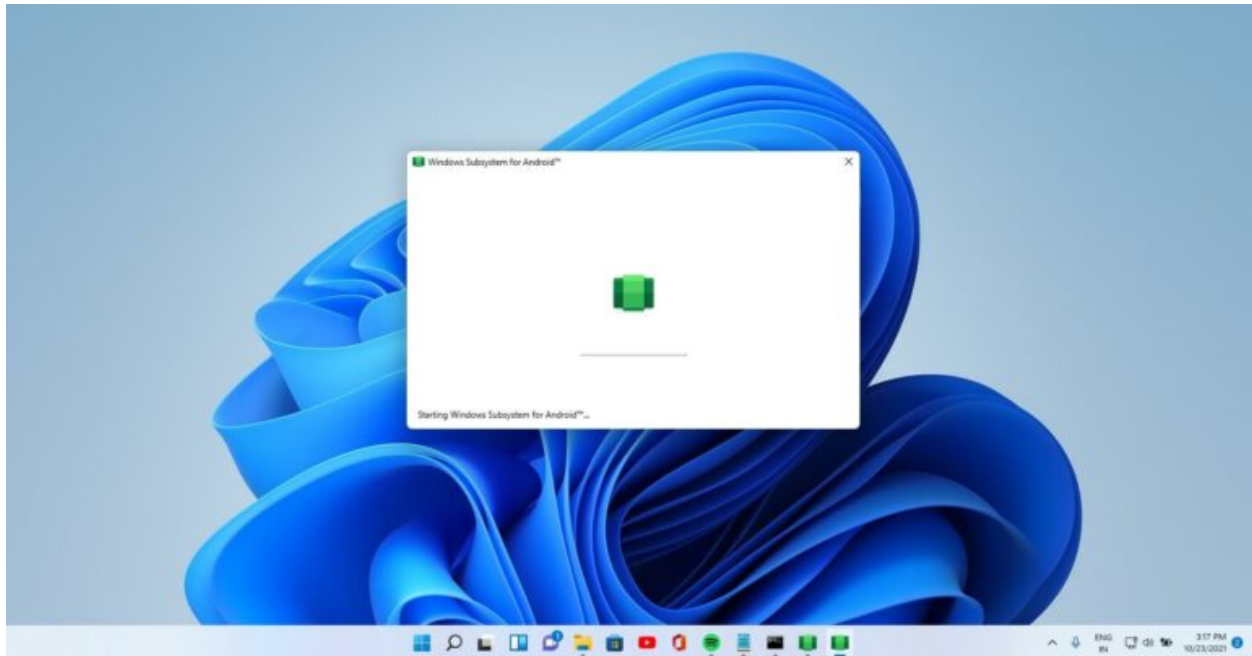


How to sideload Android apps on Windows 11 without Insider program

By **Mayank Parmar** - October 24, 2021



Android Subsystem for Windows 11 is one of the biggest new features that was originally supposed to come on October 5. It turns out that Microsoft needs more time to test the subsystem and it has started rolling out the feature to Insiders, but a simple trick now lets you sideload Android apps on Windows 11 without joining the beta channel.

Microsoft has confirmed that testers in the United States can download and install Android apps from the Amazon AppStore on Windows 11. However, [Android Subsystem for Windows 11 is rolling out in stages](#), so the Amazon AppStore may not download when the Store app is not updated.

Windows 11's Android Subsystem is available on eligible devices with Intel, AMD, and Qualcomm processors. Additionally, a minimum of 8GB of RAM is required to sideload Android APKs on Windows 11, while 16GB of RAM is recommended for the best experience on supported devices.

Sideload APKs on Windows 11

Thanks to WSA, we can sideload Android apps on Windows 11 without Google Play Store. It also lets you install and use mobile apps that you can't find through app stores like Amazon, Google or Samsung.

What's great about the Android Subsystem for Windows is that it lets you install nearly all Android apps without making changes to device settings. The process is similar to sideloading apps on your phone, but you should be familiar with Command Prompt.

In this guide, we'll talk about the simplest ways of sideloading apps on Windows 11 using Command Prompt. The method is easy to follow, so let's take a look at how it works.

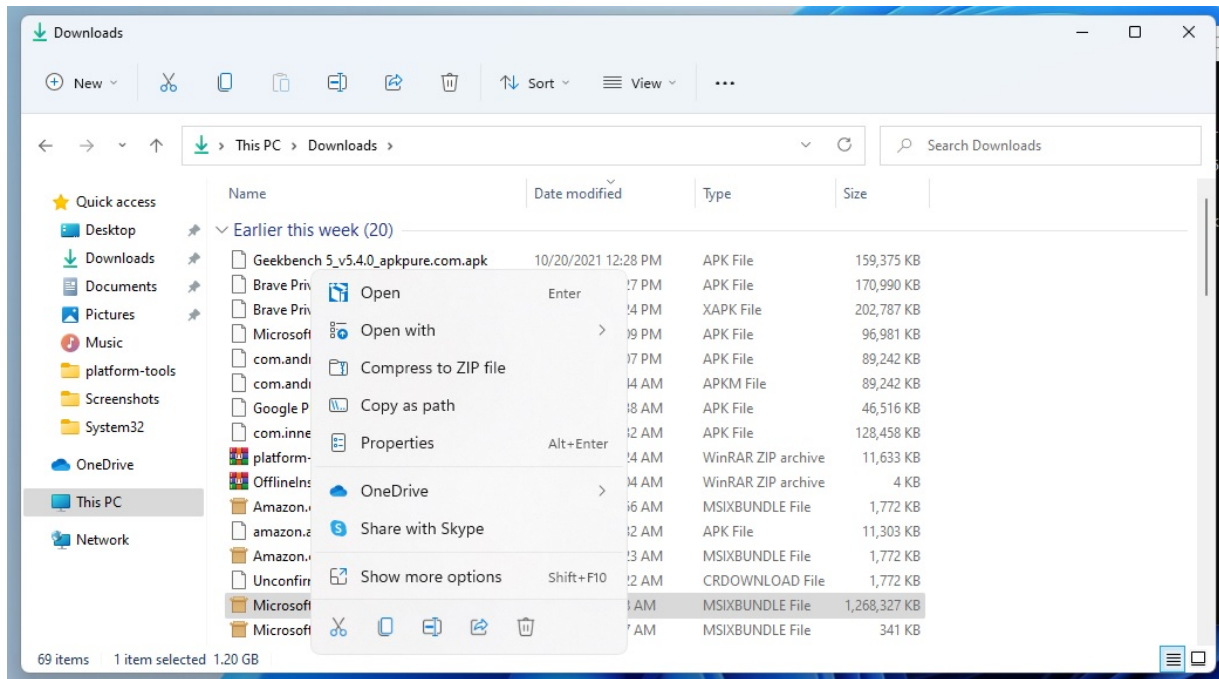
How to sideload apps on Windows 11 using Command Prompt

If you know the basics of Command Prompt and ADB (Android Debug Bridge), sideloading APKs on your Windows 11 PC can be a piece of cake.

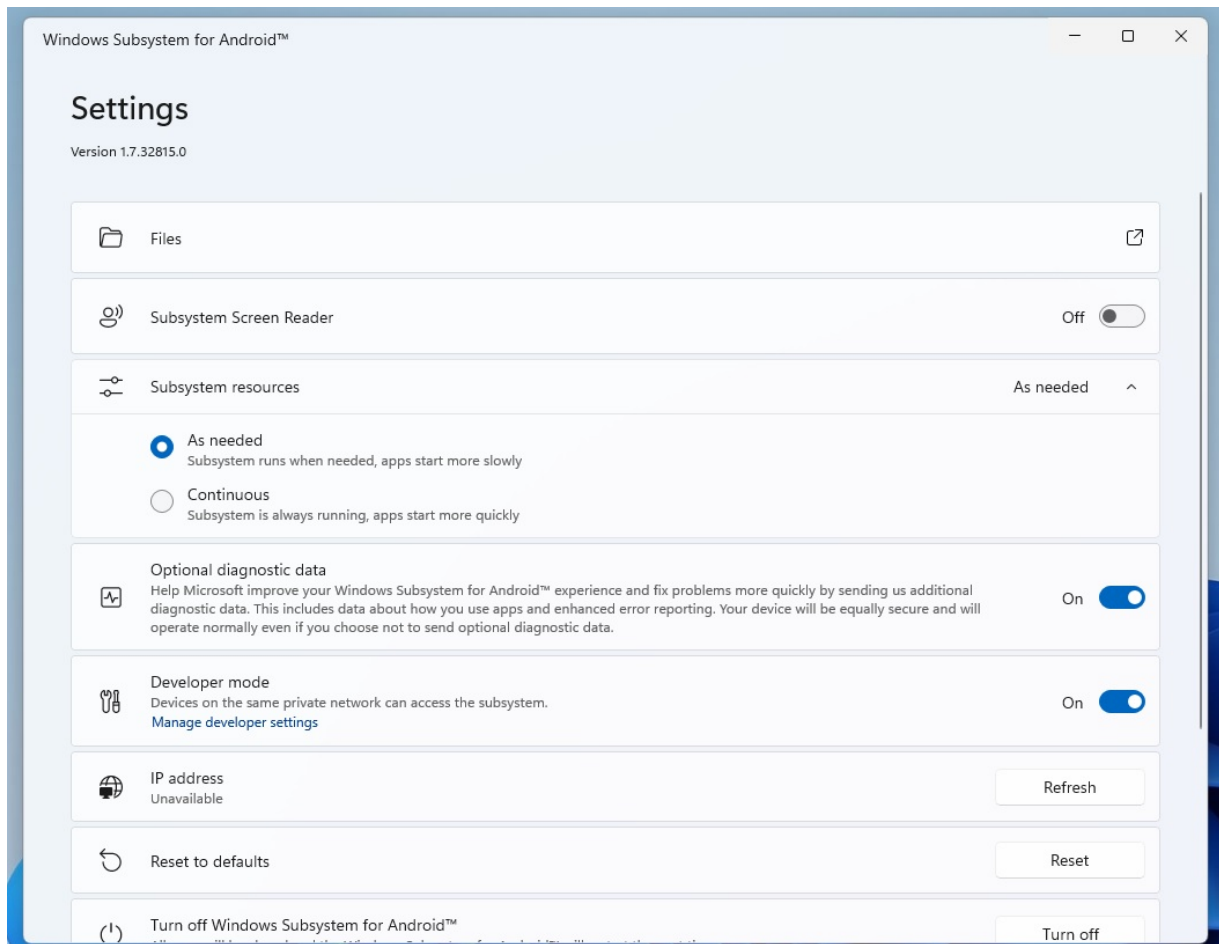
Before getting started, make sure you've downloaded APKs for apps you want to install on your device. For this article, we chose to install the Brave browser downloaded from APKMirror.

To sideload Android APKs on Windows 11 using WSA without joining the beta channel, follow these steps:

1. Download **Windows Subsystem for Android** from [here](#).
2. Open **PowerShell** (admin).
3. Enter **Add-AppxPackage** <path to file>
(To get the path of WSA, right-click on it and select **"Copy as path"**, and paste it in the above command).



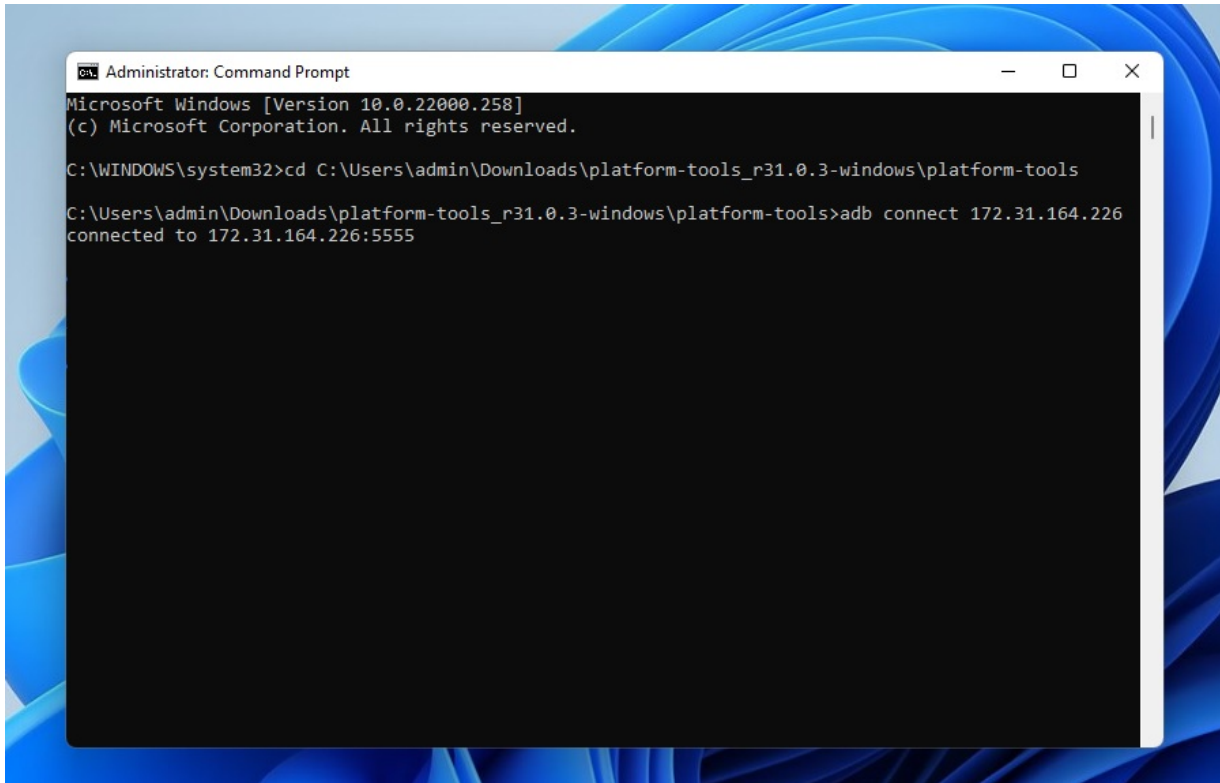
4. Head to [Google's website](#) and download the **Android SDK Platform-Tools**.
5. Extract Android SDK Platform-Tools to a folder of your choice.
6. Open **Windows Search** and type **"Windows Subsystem for Android"**, and click on it.
7. Inside **"Windows Subsystem for Android"**, scroll down and turn on **"Developer mode"**.
8. Click on **"Files"** to get the IP address. This step is required when the IP address is unavailable on the settings page.



9. If you still do not see the IP address, click **Refresh** or reopen the settings.

10. Once done, open Command Prompt.

11. Use **cd** command to navigate to the folder of Android SDK Platform-Tools. For example, if you extracted the tools in the Downloads folder, you would need to type **cd c:\users\username\downloads\platform-tools** and press enter.

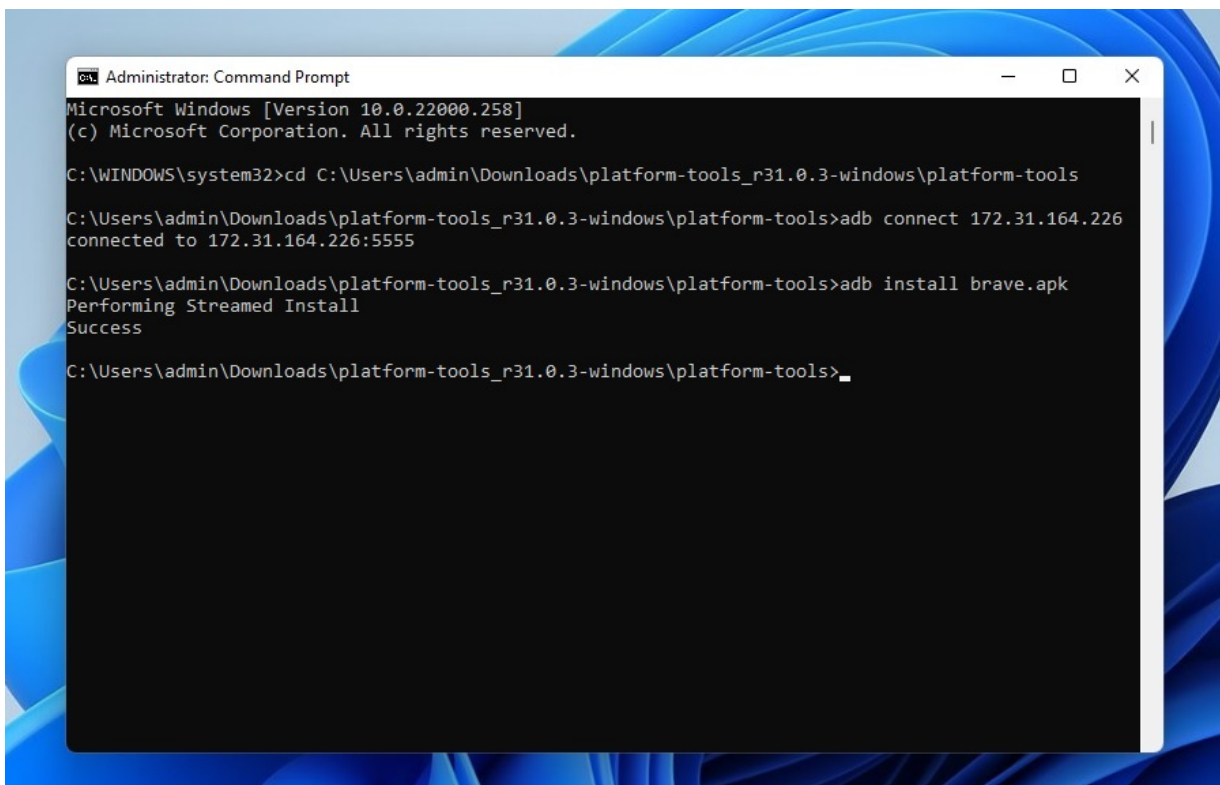
A screenshot of a Windows Command Prompt window titled "Administrator: Command Prompt". The window shows the following text: "Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.22000.258] (c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved. C:\WINDOWS\system32>cd C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools>adb connect 172.31.164.226 connected to 172.31.164.226:5555". The background of the desktop is a blue abstract pattern.

```
Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.22000.258]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\WINDOWS\system32>cd C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools
C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools>adb connect 172.31.164.226
connected to 172.31.164.226:5555
```

12. In the Command Prompt, enter **adb connect** ipaddress that you copied earlier.

13. To install the APK, use **adb install** appname.apk. In this case, we're using brave.apk (brave browser), so we entered the following command: **adb install brave.apk**

A screenshot of a Windows Command Prompt window titled "Administrator: Command Prompt". The window shows the following text: "Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.22000.258] (c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved. C:\WINDOWS\system32>cd C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools>adb connect 172.31.164.226 connected to 172.31.164.226:5555 C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools>adb install brave.apk Performing Streamed Install Success C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools>". The background of the desktop is a blue abstract pattern.

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Administrator: Command Prompt
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C:\WINDOWS\system32>cd C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools
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connected to 172.31.164.226:5555

C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools>adb install brave.apk
Performing Streamed Install
Success

C:\Users\admin\Downloads\platform-tools_r31.0.3-windows\platform-tools>
```

14. If you followed the steps correctly, a success message will appear in the Command Prompt.

You will find the app listed in your Start menu and these Android apps can be uninstalled like other apps.

